Unit 12B · A clever baby! (practice)

Speaking · 12 sets · for the teacher

How to use it. Pick a set, read the questions, point to the words. Let students answer in their own way: the green line is only a model. The first sets push today's grammar, the middle sets bring back older grammar, and the last sets are open and creative.

1 Our family album

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **family album** · look through · in the photo · old

Do you have a family album? What is in it?
→ Yes, we do. There are old photos of my grandparents and my baby photos.

When do you look through it?
→ We look through it on Sundays and when we have guests.

Who was in your favorite photo?
→ My mom, my dad and I were in the photo. We were at the sea.

Why do you like it?
→ I like it because everybody was cheerful and young.

2 Then and now: me

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **baby** · small · tall · hair · but

What was different about you when you were five?
→ I was small, but now I'm tall. I had short hair, but now it's long.

What was the same?
→ I was cheerful then, and I'm cheerful now.

What were you afraid of when you were small?
→ I was afraid of the dark, but now I'm not.

Tell me about your first friend. What was he or she like?
→ She was funny and friendly, but a little shy.

3 My cousins and me

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **cousin** · get on with · friendly · funny

Do you have cousins? How many?
→ Yes, I do. I have four cousins: two girls and two boys.

Do you get on with them?
→ Yes, I get on well with them. They're friendly and funny.

What were they like when they were small?
→ They were small and noisy, but they were cheerful.

Who do you take after in your family?
→ I take after my dad. We are both tall.

4 Curly hair runs in the family

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **run in the family** · curly · brown eyes · take after

What runs in your family: hair, eyes, a talent?
→ Curly hair runs in our family. My dad and I both have it.

What did your grandma look like?
→ She had straight gray hair, but she was pretty.

Are you named after somebody?
→ Yes, I'm named after my grandpa. His name was Alan.

Do you look like your mom or your dad?
→ I look like my mom, but I'm tall like my dad.

5 A grandma with four children

IMAGINE

Push these words: **bring up** · generous · tired · busy

Imagine you are a grandma with four children. Are you busy?
→ Yes, I am. I'm very busy, but I'm cheerful.

What do you have in your kitchen?
→ I have a big table and a lot of plates.

Are you strict or generous?
→ I'm generous, but I'm not mean to anybody.

What was it like in your house long ago?
→ There wasn't a lot of money, but there was a lot of love.

6 Photos of the past

IMAGINE

Push these words: **photo** · old · young · black and white

Imagine an old photo of your family. Who is in it?
→ My grandma and my grandpa are in it.

What were they like?
→ They were young and handsome.

What did your grandma have?
→ She had long hair and a big smile.

Was the photo black and white?
→ Yes, it was.

7 A long sentence challenge

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **and** · but · when I was · I had

Say a sentence with when I was... and and.
→ When I was five, I was small and cheerful.

Say a sentence with but about your grandpa.
→ My grandpa was old, but he was very strong.

Say a sentence with had and but.
→ I had a bike, but I didn't have a helmet.

Say a sentence with weren't and because.
→ We weren't tired because we were happy.

8 Old and new

OPINION

Push these words: **old-fashioned** · better · because · there wasn't

Are old photos better than new photos? Why?
→ I think old photos are better because they are black and white and special.

Were people's clothes old-fashioned in the past?
→ Yes, they were. The dresses were long and the hats were big.

Is it better to have a lot of photos or only a few?
→ I think a few, because then every photo is important.

Why do we keep old photos?
→ We keep them because we remember our family.

9 Rules at home

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **must** · mustn't · wash · quiet · homework

What must you do at home every day?
→ I must do my homework and I must wash my hands before dinner.

What mustn't you do at the table?
→ You mustn't talk with food in your mouth.

Was there a rule at home when you were small? What was it?
→ Yes, there was. I mustn't watch TV after eight o'clock.

What rule is the best for kids?
→ You must be kind to everybody. That's the best rule.

10 A place I love

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **there was** · there were · beautiful · quiet · fountain

What's your favorite place in our town? What's it like?
→ My favorite place is the park. It's big and quiet, and it's beautiful.

What is there in it? Are there any animals?
→ There's a lake and a fountain. There are ducks and squirrels.

What was there fifty years ago? Was it the same?
→ No, it wasn't. There wasn't a fountain, but there was a small pond.

Who is with you when you go there?
→ My family and my friends are with me. We have a picnic.

11 What if...

IMAGINE

Push these words: **was / were** · queen · pilot · famous · crown

Imagine your grandma was a queen. Tell me what she had.
→ She had a crown and a big castle.

Imagine your dad is a pilot. Where does he go?
→ He goes to a lot of countries. He has a big uniform.

Imagine you are famous. What is your life like?
→ I travel a lot and I meet interesting people.

Which was better, a king's life or a farmer's life?
→ I think a farmer's life was better: it was quieter.

12 A story to retell

IMAGINE

Push these words: **goat** · wolf · door · careful · voice

Tell me the story of the little goats in 5 sentences.

→ A mother goat has three little goats. She goes to the market. A wolf knocks on the door...

What did the mother say? What mustn't the goats do?

→ You mustn't open the door.

Was the wolf's voice soft or rough?

→ It was rough first. Then it was soft, but the paws were black.

Who was clever in the story? Why?

→ The little goats were clever because they look at the paws.